



For AMD processors (Mid-Range)

MSI K8N Neo Platinum

Specs: : Socket 754, AGP 8x Port, Four SATA With RAID, Gigabit LAN, Eight-Channel Audio, Four USB 2.0 Ports, FireWire

Our Verdict: The MSI K8N Neo Platinum is based on the nVidia nForce3 250Gb chipset. It has the best component layout in its class, with a processor area free of capacitors and perfectly placed storage ports.

Scoring a very healthy score of 32 in the real world benchmark Multimedia Content Creation 2004 and 3640 in

PCMark04

proves the prowess of this motherboard in handling day-to-day office applications such as word processors, spreadsheets, etc. Being a Platinum series motherboard, it comes with a generous bundle of goodies in addition to its features, yet it is reasonably priced. Add everything up and what we have is the winner of the Zero One award.



Runner-Up: [Asus K8N-E Deluxe](#)

For Intel processors (Mid-Range)

Gigabyte GA-8I915G Duo

Specs: Socket LGA775, x16 PCI-Express, 4 SATA Ports, Supports DDR and DDR-II (400/533), On board Video and 7.1 Channel sound

Our Verdict: Based on the Intel 915G chipset, this motherboard is skilfully designed with pack of features – supporting both DDR and DDR2, 7.1 channel sound, Gigabit LAN and it also sported x16 PCI express slot when most AMD motherboards were reluctant to implement it. The on-board video satisfies the light gaming experience for a casual

gamer; the hard-core gamers can of course add-in the fast PCI express graphic card. Since

915 chipset board use ICH6 Southbridge, the support for SATA storage media is excellent especially for I/O intensive work that needs higher data transfer rates. Although this board isn't an outright performer, it is a value for money product.



Runner-Up: [Gigabyte GA-8I915G MF](#)

For AMD Processors (High-End)

Gigabyte 8S Series GA-K8NXP-SLI

Specs: Socket 939, Supports AMD Athlon64 X2, nVidia nForce4 SLI Chipset, Eight SATA-2 Ports with Hot PnP, Dual Gigabit LAN, Dual BIOS

Our Verdict: This motherboard comes with a lot of bundled goodies such as the U-Plus DPS power system, an 802.11b+g Wi-Fi card, and lots of cables and connectors. The board posted very high gaming scores, and it returned excellent scores in the Content Creation and Business Winstone benchmark applications, which are indicative of real-world performance in office applications.

Future-proofing is the name of the

game: this motherboard supports the dual-core AMD Athlon64

X2, and even has very good overclocking features if you really want to push it to the limits.

If you're looking to invest in a motherboard for an AMD processor that's packed to the gills with features and that offers top-notch performance, look no further than the Gigabyte 8S Series GA-K8NXP-SLI!



Runner-Up: [Asus Proactive A8N-SLI](#)

MSI MegaView 561

The MegaView 561 is MSI's answer to the iPods and iRivers in the media player segment. This player has a respectable 3.5-inch TFT LCD screen, and 20 GB of storage capacity. The device supports viewing and playback of the DivX, MPEG-4, WMV, WMA, GIF, TIFF, JPEG and BMP formats.

Other features include voice recording and an FM tuner programmable up to eight stations. The microphone is very sensitive; it records ambient sounds with good clarity. Using AV

cables, MegaView can record from and play back to a TV.

A little more horsepower to play video of higher bitrates without stutter would have made the MegaView 561 truly impressive, but the 561 is still a very decent portable player.

